

cial way of creating the XMLHttpRequest. You can see how to detect the browser, and create the XMLHttpRequest object in the code example.

```
function createAJAXObject(){
    var httpReq;
    try {
        httpReq = new XMLHttpRequest();
    }
    catch (e) {
        try {
            httpReq = new ActiveXObject("Msxml2.
XMLHTTP");
        }
        catch (e) {
            try {
                httpReq = new ActiveXObject("Microsoft.
XMLHTTP");
            }
            catch (e) {
                return false;
            }
        }
    }
}
```

In this example, we are using the try...catch mechanism to create an AJAX object. The catch clause is executed if there is an error in the first attempt. Then it tries to create the object using ActiveX, as used by older versions of IE. If all else fails, it returns false indicating that AJAX will not work on the browser.

Now let us really get started, we will now develop a movie database, you can download the sample data from the Digit web site, or create your own. The sample data contains a list of the top 100 earning movies. The data is out of date; however it is suitable for our purposes. Download and play the file in the same directory as the one in which you place the HTML file you create.

To truly make this an AJAX application, we will have to do the following:

- Load an external XML file containing the data
- Create an HTML representation of the data
- Place it in the desired location in the document